



Notification Waiver Determination

Blackstone – Acacium Group

Acquisition	Funds advised and/or managed by affiliates of Blackstone Inc. (Blackstone) proposes to acquire more than 20% of the equity in Acacium Group Limited (Acacium Group) pursuant to a debt-for-equity swap, as described in the transaction documents provided as part of the application (the Acquisition). Blackstone Alternative Credit Advisors LP applied for a notification waiver in respect of the Acquisition.
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABV(1)(a) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition is not required to be notified.
Date of determination	8 July 2026

Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, Blackstone, is a global alternative asset manager. It is headquartered in the United States and has offices in Europe and Asia. Blackstone is listed on the New York Stock Exchange and operates as an investment management firm. The target, Acacium Group, is a global health care and life science delivery partner. Its principal activities are the provision of workforce solutions and managed services across health and social care staffing, health and social care managed services and life sciences. The Acacium Group operates across the UK, the US, Europe, Asia and Australia.
Explanation for determination	In making this notification waiver determination, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (the ACCC) has considered the information provided with the notification waiver application and certain publicly available information, and had regard to the factors in section 51ABV(2)(b) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). Based on the information currently before it, the ACCC considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to give rise to any material lessening of competition. In particular: a. there is no horizontal overlap between Blackstone, its portfolio companies and Acacium Group b. there are alternative suppliers of healthcare staffing services in Australia c. there is a low risk of foreclosure or other concerning vertical effects resulting from exclusionary conduct post-acquisition.

	In these circumstances, the ACCC does not consider it necessary to reach a concluded view on the likelihood of the notification thresholds being met. Given that material competition concerns are unlikely to arise, the ACCC has determined that the Acquisition is not required to be notified. The ACCC considers that the determination is consistent with the object of the Act and the interests of consumers in promoting competition. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notification waiver applications and to assessing competition effects more generally, see the ACCC's interim guidance on notification waivers and merger assessment guidelines.
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**Determination made by Commissioner Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1)
of the Act**